- Management of informative system
- Maternal and child health services
- Treatment of minor ailments
- Organising of clinics and camps
- Waste management

1.7 CARE FOR THE CHALLENGED PERSON



Challenged person is one who deviated from normal health status either physically, mentally or socially. Children who are affected that way require special care, treatment and education.

The Challenged Children can be classified as follows

- Physically challenged children: e.g., blindness, deaf, mute, harelip, cleft palate, crippled – polio, cerebral palsy, heart diseases, road accidents, burns and injuries.
- Psychological challenged: orphans, maternal deprivation, emotional deprivation, and maladjustment
- Mentally challenged children: feeble minded, mental defect and mental retardation

All these problems may be genetic or due to certain specific diseases, injuries, social factors or nutritional factors.

From the community point of view it is essential that such children in need of help should be taken care. Parents of such children should also play a major part in planning the care.

The objective of the care in such situation is to improve the physical condition, prevent further damage and then to help, secure a suitable occupation.

Major Causes

- Malnutrition – is another major disability causing factor
- Accidents on the roads and play at home can be another cause
- Genetic disorders and birth defects
- Effects of drugs

The aim of home health nursing is to assist the individual who has a disability and/or chronic illness in restoring, maintaining and promoting his or her maximum health. This includes preventing chronic illness, and disability. The home health nurse is skilled at treating alternations in functional ability, and lifestyle that result from physical disability and chronic illness.

Responsibilities of The Home Health Nurse

- To guide the parent in getting early treatment to prevent further damage and improve the physical condition, e.g., physiotherapy, through which the deformities could be corrected. This knowledge has to be imparted to parents, e.g., as in case of polio
- To provide occupational therapy. A child who is challenged can be trained to choose any craft according to his ability such as carpentry, painting, cloth weaving or mat weaving

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